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TRUMP'S IRAN DEAL CLAIMS RAISE HOPES

■ US ENVOYS 'HELD TALKS WITH RESPECTED IRANIAN LEADER'

■ US PRESIDENT CLAIMS 'MAJOR POINTS OF AGREEMENT' WITH TEHRAN

■ 'REGIME CHANGE UNDERWAY, SAYS TRUMP BUT IRAN DENIES TALKS

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

Hopes for a resolution to the US-Israeli conflict with Iran rose yesterday after President Donald Trump signalled progress in talks, even as Tehran denied that any negotiations were taking place.

Trump extended his deadline for Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, pausing planned strikes on Iranian power plants for five days.

In a post on Truth Social, Trump said the United States would hold off military action after "very good and productive conversations" over the past two days aimed at a "complete and total resolution" of the conflict.

Trump later told reporters that Iran wants "to make a deal" and claimed US envoys — including his Middle East special envoy, Steve Witkoff, and adviser Jared Kushner — held talks late Sunday with a "respected" Iranian leader, though he did not identify who was representing Tehran.

Deal in the making?

"They want to make a deal, and we are very willing to make a deal," he said.

He added that there were already "major points of agreement," including US demands that Iran abandon nuclear ambitions and give up its enriched uranium stockpiles. "We want no enrichment, but we also want the enriched uranium," Trump said.

Trump warned that the pause



UAE Presidential Court

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Aleksandar Vucic, President of Serbia, discussed developments in the region amid the ongoing military escalation and its serious implications for regional and international security and stability on Sunday in Abu Dhabi.

in military action would be temporary. "If it doesn't work out, we'll just keep bombing our little hearts out," he said.

He went further, saying that "regime change" was underway in Iran as the United States engaged with alternative leadership, though he provided no details on who was involved.

'Things going well'

Earlier, Trump told AFP in a brief interview that "things are going very well," signalling confidence in the prospects for a deal. Despite these claims, Iran's foreign ministry denied that any negotiations with the United

States had taken place. State media said Trump had backed down "following Iran's firm warning."

Trump insisted the US was in contact with alternative leadership in Iran, describing the interlocutor as "a top person" and "the most respected and the leader," while saying it was "not the supreme leader," Mojtaba Khamenei.

"We think we have people that are very representative of the country and will do a good job," he said, adding that identities were being withheld "because I don't want them to be killed."

The US president also suggested a deal could resemble

developments in Venezuela, where Washington backed a new leadership arrangement.

"Look at Venezuela, how well that's working out," he said.

Meanwhile, attacks on Gulf states continued, with Saudi Arabia, Bahrain and Kuwait intercepting missiles and drones amid escalating regional tensions. In the UAE, air defence systems intercepted seven ballistic missiles and 16 drones launched from Iran, with debris falling in populated areas.

An Indian national sustained minor injuries after debris fell in the Al Shawamekh area.

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UAE'S SOVEREIGN RIGHT

Abdullah: We will never be blackmailed by terrorists

DUBAI

BY KHITAM ALAMIR

Chief News Editor

The UAE has said it will never be blackmailed by terrorists, reaffirming its sovereign right to make strategic security decisions amid ongoing regional tensions.

"We will never be blackmailed by terrorists," Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, said in a post on social media platform X.

The remarks came in response to comments by Gérard Araud, a former French ambassador, who had questioned the UAE's position on its security partnerships during a period of heightened hostilities in the region.

Araud had cited a report referencing remarks by Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, prompting wider discussion over the UAE's strategic approach.

Weak collective regional response

In a separate post, Gargash questioned the response of Arab and Islamic institutions to the Iranian aggression against Gulf countries, calling attention to the lack of collective regional action. He asked where key organisations such as the Arab League and the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation are as Gulf states faced security threats, and also questioned the position of major Arab and regional powers.

Gargash said the absence of a stronger regional response made it difficult to later criticise the role of the United States and Western countries in the region or to speak about a decline in Arab and Islamic influence.

Lasting Gulf security beyond a ceasefire

In another post, he wrote: "UAE confronts Iran's blatant aggression and demonstrates our strength in resilience and steadfastness, our focus goes beyond a ceasefire to solutions that ensure lasting security in the Arabian Gulf, address the nuclear threat, missiles and drones, and put an end to the intimidation of vital waterways."

"It is unacceptable for aggression to become a permanent state of threat," Gargash wrote.

UAE braces for unstable weather this week

Death toll in Oman flash floods reaches six as severe weather persists

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The death toll from flash floods in Oman has risen to six after a 7-year-old boy drowned in a water pool in Barka, while search teams recovered the body of a missing woman swept away by floodwaters.

Meanwhile, the UAE is bracing for more unstable weather, with authorities warning of continued rainfall, thunderstorms and strong winds across several regions.

The National Centre of Meteorology (NCM) said intermittent rain is expected in parts of the country, along with a noticeable drop in temperatures.

Official safety guidance

Residents have been urged to stay updated on weather alerts and follow official safety guidance as conditions remain unpredictable.

Oman's National Emergency Management Committee confirmed that the child died after

Residents in the UAE have been urged to stay updated on weather alerts and follow official safety guidance as conditions remain unpredictable.

a drowning incident in a pool in the Wilayat of Barka, in South Al Batinah Governorate. The boy was pronounced dead upon arrival at the hospital.

Authorities said the fatality is linked to the ongoing Al-Masarat Trough weather system, which has brought heavy rainfall and dangerous conditions across parts of the sultanate.

In a separate incident, search and rescue teams recovered the body of a woman who had gone missing after a vehicle was swept away by flash floods in Barka.

The victim, identified as Ramlath, was travelling with a group during the Eid Al Fitr holiday when their vehicle was caught in a sudden surge of floodwater while attempting to cross a wadi.

Authorities had earlier confirmed the deaths of two Indian expatriates from Kerala — Yusuf, 38, and Shamla, 32 — in the same incident.

SEE ALSO P3



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ Office-goers at Business Bay in Dubai yesterday. The NCM expects intermittent rainfall during the day today. The weather condition is expected to continue tomorrow.

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Man City win EFL Cup — 25 titles under Abu Dhabi United Group | P13



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ENTERTAINMENT

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